

LUNA HOU

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EDUCATION

M.F.A. in Writing (Fiction)

Columbia University – New York, NY | May 2029

B.A. in English, Minor in Creative Writing, *summa cum laude*

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2025

Honors Thesis: “Song Cycle.” A 1000-line manuscript of poems.

WRITING & HUMANITIES TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Assistant in the Digital Humanities

Barnard College – New York, NY | Oct 2026 – Present

Writing Center Consultant

Columbia University – New York, NY | Jun 2026 – Present

Guest Instructor, Introduction to Poetry

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill – Chapel Hill, NC | Nov 2025

- Taught a lesson for an undergraduate poetry course on traditional and contemporary poetic forms
- Prepared original materials and facilitated discussion, close reading, and guided writing exercises

Undergraduate Course Instructor

Carolina Students Taking Academic Responsibility through Teaching – Chapel Hill, NC | Aug 2023 – May 2024

- Led a weekly, 2-hour class of 10 undergraduates in the spring semester, moderating seminar-style analytical discussions and creative writing workshops focused on original student poems
- Provided detailed constructive feedback on academic and creative work via written comments on weekly assignments and individual conferences, focusing on literary analysis and revision strategies
- Designed a detailed syllabus for a semester-long course, including course readings and textbooks, assignments, presentation slides, and final project instructions to create a collaborative literary zine
- Researched contemporary Asian American poetry under the supervision of a faculty mentor, with a focus on 21st-century queer voices in relation to ongoing social, political, and historical movements

English as a Second Language Instructor

DanSummit – Remote | Sep 2019 – Jan 2022

- Tutored 3 students in English, helping to develop their reading, writing, and speaking skills
- Provided structured, individualized verbal and written feedback on homework and class assignments on a weekly basis to guide student learning and growth

English as a Second Language Instructor

DanSummit – Lin'an, Hangzhou, Zhejiang, China | July 2019

- Facilitated daily lessons and team-building activities to strengthen students' English language and leadership skills, including instruction in grammar, oral presentation, and professional writing

ADDITIONAL TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Lead Piano Instructor

Meadowlark Music School – Chapel Hill, NC | Apr 2025 – Jul 2026

- Plan and lead weekly individual lessons for students with a focus on technique, music theory, and joy, nurturing creativity, confidence, and resilience
- Mentor students of diverse skill levels, ages, backgrounds, and learning styles

EDITORIAL EXPERIENCE

Prose Reader

Bull City Press – Durham, NC | Jun 2025 – Present

- Review high volumes of fiction and nonfiction submissions with attention to craft and literary merit
- Contribute to a small, collaborative team to discuss submissions, offer editorial feedback, and select the strongest manuscripts for publication

Editor in Chief

Cellar Door Literary Magazine – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2024 – May 2025

- Oversaw the publication of UNC's oldest literary magazine, including print and online submission selection, layout and design, copyedits, and planning a reading to recognize magazine contributors
- Communicated with administration and publishing companies concerning finances and publicity

Curator

COALESCE Exhibition – Hillsborough, NC | Aug 2024 – Jan 2025

- Evaluated poetry submissions for strong technical quality and artistic vision
- Collaborated with organizers to select a diverse representation of artists to participate in exhibition

Editorial Intern

Hachette Book Group: Algonquin Books – New York City, NY | Jan 2024 – May 2024

- Logged, reviewed, and drafted incisive reader's reports on literary fiction and nonfiction manuscripts
- Participated in weekly editorial meetings, offering insights on content quality and appeal based on industry and entertainment trends and recording meeting notes
- Provided administrative support for editors; crafted paperback materials for forthcoming titles

Poetry Editor

Cellar Door Literary Magazine – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2023 – May 2024

- Led a staff of nine readers to select poetry submissions of the highest caliber to be published
- Acted as a liaison between staff, authors, and editorial board to assemble and refine submissions

Poetry Editor

Short Story UNC – Chapel Hill, NC | Apr 2022 – Aug 2023

- Greenlighted poems to be published in specialized dispensers throughout the local community
- Coordinated and co-judged 2 annual writing contests to recognize outstanding writers on campus

HONORS & AWARDS

2025	Pushcart Prize Nominee, <i>Fractured Lit</i>
2025	Katharine Bakeless Nason Participant Scholar in Fiction, Bread Loaf Writers' Conference <i>Offered to applicants at the early stages of their writing career whose writing shows exceptional promise. Scholarships cover tuition, room, and board at the conference.</i>
2025	Fiction Participant, Kenyon Writers Workshop
2025	Dorianne Laux Poetry Prize Winner, North Carolina State University Poetry Contest <i>The annual NC State Poetry Contest is a free literary competition open to all North Carolina residents. It remains one of the largest free-to-enter poetry contests in the South.</i>
2024	Shorter Fiction Prize Winner, North Carolina State University Fiction Contest <i>The annual NC State Fiction Contest is a free literary competition open to all North Carolina residents. It remains one of the largest free-to-enter fiction contests in the South.</i>
2024	Fiction Scholar, Juniper Summer Writing Institute <i>Attended on full scholarship.</i>
2024	Suzanne Bolch Summer Travel Scholarship Winner, UNC-Chapel Hill <i>Provides summer support to a creative writing minor who seeks to develop an original, independent project designed to stimulate and expand the writer's imagination and artistic vision.</i>
2023	One Teen Story Ages 18-19 National Category Winner, One Story <i>Wrote a short story singularly selected from over 500 submissions as the Ages 18-19 National Category Winner of One Teen Story, a free national writing competition for all writers ages 13-19.</i>
2021	Summer Bridge Scholar, UNC-Chapel Hill
2020	National Gold Medal in Flash Fiction, Scholastic Art & Writing Awards

PUBLICATIONS

Creative Writing

Fiction

2026	"The Dragonfly," <i>Uncanny Magazine</i>
2025	"Moon Rabbit," <i>Fractured Lit</i>
2023	"Railroads," <i>One Teen Story</i>

Poetry

- 2027 “Siren Song,” *Uncanny Magazine*
- 2026 “Self-Portrait as Eurydice,” *Anathema Magazine*
- 2026 “Portrait of Girlhood as Icarus,” *Anathema Magazine*

Invited Readings

- 2025 Featured Writer, Common Roots Festival, North Carolina Asian Americans Together. Durham, NC. – May 17th, 2025
- 2025 Featured Poet, Bodies in Motion: The Poet in Diaspora, Indigena Collective. Raleigh, NC. – April 13th, 2025
- 2025 Featured Poet, Women’s History Month Celebration, Town of Carrboro. Carrboro, NC. – March 1st, 2025
- 2024 Featured Writer, Bull City Press Reading Series, Bull City Press. Durham, NC. – July 27th, 2024
- 2024 Featured Poet, Women’s History Month Celebration, Town of Carrboro. Carrboro, NC. – March 1st, 2024
- 2023 Featured Poet. Coalesce exhibition, Orange County Arts Commission. Hillsborough, NC. – January 5th, 2023

Interviews

- 2023 “Q&A by Patrick Ryan,” *One Story*
- 2023 “Student Spotlight: Luna Hou,” UNC English & Comparative Literature Department

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT

Vice President

Asian American Creative Writing Collective – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2024 – May 2025

- Organized semesterly open mics for students to showcase their creative work in the local community
- Assisted with the advertising, formatting, and selection of pieces for literary magazine *Infusions*
- Guided workshops, discussions, and writing exercises during bimonthly meetings

Publicity Chair

Asian American Creative Writing Collective – Chapel Hill, NC | May 2023 – May 2024

- Facilitated connections with other organizations, helping to plan and promote collaborative events
- Managed club social media, designing bimonthly Instagram posts and other promotional materials

Research Intern

Southern Oral History Program – Chapel Hill, NC | Aug 2023 – Dec 2023

- Conducted and transcribed two oral history interviews for Southern Mix, a project aiming to record and amplify the diverse and authentic experiences of Asians and Asian Americans in the South
- Designed an ethnopoetic zine combining original oral history research and secondary scholarship